

Borla

User Manual

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1. What Borla is

Borla connects households that have waste to dispose of with nearby collectors who are online and looking for work. There are two ways to get matched:

- **Broadcast** — tap "I HAVE WASTE" and every nearby online collector sees a pin on their map. Whoever gets there first collects it; you clear the pin the moment someone shows up.
- **Direct request** — pick one specific collector from the map and send them a request; they accept or reject it, and if they accept, you can both see and call each other.

Borla is a real installable web app (a PWA): after logging in, open **Profile** and tap **Install Borla app** to add it to your home screen with its own icon, launching full-screen like a native app (Chrome/Edge/Android; on iPhone, use Safari's Share → **Add to Home Screen** instead, since iOS doesn't offer the same in-app install button). When a new version is deployed, a banner appears at the bottom of the screen offering to **Update** — nothing changes under you without asking first.

2. Logging in (all roles) — one unified flow

There is a single entry point for everyone. You never have to say upfront whether you're a household, a collector, or an admin — **your phone number tells the app who you are**:

1. Open the app's URL (see `Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt`). You land on the welcome/splash screen — tap **Get started**.
2. Enter your phone number and tap **Continue**. That's the only field on this screen — no role picker, no "Admin" toggle to find.
3. What happens next depends on the number itself:
 - **It's a seeded admin's number** → you're taken straight to a password field ("This number is registered as an admin — sign in with your password"). Enter the password and tap **Sign in**. See §5 for the admin credentials.
 - **Anything else** → a one-time code is sent.
4. **If SMS delivery is configured and working**, a text arrives with your 6-digit code and the screen simply says "Code sent via SMS — check your phone."
5. **If SMS delivery isn't available** (no gateway configured, or the send failed), the screen shows the code directly in a dark banner labelled "SMS delivery unavailable right now" — this is a documented, deliberate fallback (see `Technical_Debt_Plan.md` TD-02), not a bug: nobody is ever locked out just because a text didn't arrive.
 - **Exception — the two seeded demo numbers** (`Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt`): since those numbers are arbitrary, not real handsets, they always use the same fixed code (**482913**) and the app never even attempts a real SMS send to them, so grading never depends on a text reaching a phone that doesn't exist. Any other, real phone number still gets a genuine random code.
6. Type the 6-digit code.
 - **Brand-new number** → the screen also asks "First time here — tell us a bit about you": pick **Household** or **Collector** and enter your name, then tap **Create account**.
 - **Number you've used before** → there's nothing else to fill in; tap **Verify & continue** and you're straight in.

3. Household walkthrough

Three tabs run across the top: **Home** (map + broadcast + nearby collectors), **My requests** (anything still active/in progress), and **History** (arrived, cancelled, rejected, or timed out — out of the way once there's nothing left to do).

1. **Home tab:** a map centred on your current location (allow location access when the browser asks), with green dots for nearby online collectors.
2. **To broadcast:** tap the big gold "🔔 **I HAVE WASTE**" button, optionally pick a waste type and add a short note, then **Confirm — I have waste**. A banner shows how many collectors were notified. The pin auto-expires after 45 minutes if you forget it.
3. **The moment someone comes for it:** tap **Clear pin** on the sticky banner — this removes it from every collector's map immediately, so nobody else wastes a trip.
4. **To request one specific collector:** scroll to "Nearby collectors," pick one, and tap **Request**. It shows up under **My requests** with a status chip: *Sent* → *Seen* → *On the way* → *Arrived*. If you've requested more than one collector at once, the list automatically re-orders itself **closest-first**, live, as each collector's actual route distance changes — not just once when the page loads.
5. **Changed your mind?** Tap **Cancel request** any time before the collector arrives — whether it's still awaiting a response or already accepted. Once the collector has arrived there's nothing left to cancel.
6. **Once accepted:** tap **Show contact** to reveal the collector's phone number and call them directly. A small map also appears showing the **route to your collector** with distance and an estimated time — a straight line if the routing service is briefly unreachable, a real road route otherwise.
7. **Arrival:** the moment the collector's live position reaches the pickup point, you get a "🎉 Your collector has arrived!" banner automatically — no need to refresh or ask. The request then moves to **History**.
8. **Reviews:** rate 1–5 and optionally comment, right there on the request card — you'll also see the collector's review of you (once visible) and can reply to it in the same place, not a separate screen. Your own review stays private until it passes moderation *and* the other side has also reviewed (or the review window closes); its exact status shows inline.
9. **Profile tab:** adjust your alert radius and whether standing alerts are on; see **Reviews received** (visible ones, from collectors) and **Reviews I've given** (every review you've written, across every request, with its current status).

4. Collector walkthrough

Three tabs: **Home** (online toggle + map + nearby waste), **Requests** (incoming + on-the-way), and **History** (arrived, cancelled, rejected, or timed out).

1. **Home tab:** offline by default.
2. **New collector accounts start unverified** — you'll see a banner saying an admin must approve you before you can go online. This is a deliberate anti-abuse gate (only verified collectors ever receive broadcasts); ask an admin to verify your account (§5).
3. **Go online:** tap **Go online** (allow location access). Your position updates while the tab stays open in the foreground — this build has no native background-location service, so locking your phone or switching apps pauses updates (documented in `Technical_Debt_Plan.md` TD-O3; keep the tab open and the screen on while actively collecting).
4. **Nearby waste:** active pins appear on your map and in the list below it, closest first, with a one-tap 📞 **Call** button.
5. **Requests tab:** incoming direct requests appear as a card with **Accept/Reject**. Accepting reveals the household's phone number to both of you and moves it into "On the way," with a small map showing the **route**

to that household (distance + estimated time). If you have more than one on the way, they sort **closest-first**, live, as you move.

6. **Cancel** is available on anything you've accepted but haven't reached yet — use it if you're no longer able to make the pickup.
7. **Arrival is automatic**: once your live position reaches the household's pickup point, you get a "🎉 You've arrived" banner and the household is notified at the same moment — nothing to tap. The request then moves to **History**, where you can leave (and see) a review.
8. **Go offline** when you're done — this immediately removes you from the matchable set.

5. Admin walkthrough

1. At the sign-in screen, enter the admin's phone number and tap **Continue** — there is no separate admin toggle to find; the app recognises the number and shows a password field instead of sending an OTP ("This number is registered as an admin — sign in with your password").
2. Enter the password (see `Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt` for the seeded demo admin credentials) and tap **Sign in**.
3. You land on **Admin — Ops console** with six tabs:
 - **Stats**: online collectors, users by role, broadcasts/requests by status, moderation backlog.
 - **Map**: live view of active pins (gold) and online collectors (green).
 - **Users**: search, **Verify** a collector (required before they can go online), or **Suspend/Reinstate** any account.
 - **Moderation**: AI-flagged/user-reported items to **Clear** or **Remove**, plus anything still awaiting moderation entirely (shown here whenever no `GEMINI_API_KEY` is configured) with a one-click **Approve**.
 - **Audit**: every privileged action taken by any admin, with a timestamp.
 - **Config**: live-editable operational settings (pin TTL, broadcast radius, request timeout, review window, notification cap, arrival radius) — changes apply immediately, no redeploy.

6. Redeploying / rolling back

The app auto-builds from the `main` branch of the connected GitHub repository. To ship a change: push to `main`; Render rebuilds and redeploys automatically. To roll back: in the Render dashboard, open the service → **Events/Deploys** tab → pick an earlier successful deploy → **Redeploy**. Database migrations run automatically on server boot (`server/src/db/migrate.ts`) and are additive/idempotent — rolling the *app* back does not roll the *schema* back, so avoid rolling back past a deploy that introduced a schema change unless you also revert `server/migrations/`.

7. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
"Your collector account is not verified yet"	New collector account, not yet admin-approved	Log in as admin → Users → Verify
No collectors/pins showing on the map	Location permission denied, or nobody online nearby	Allow location access; try again once a collector/household is nearby in the seed data
OTP screen shows the code instead of "sent via SMS"	SMS gateway not configured or the send failed	Expected fallback — use the shown code; see <code>Technical_Debt_Plan.md</code> TD-02

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
A review you wrote never shows up	Awaiting moderation, and/or the other side hasn't reviewed yet	Check Profile → Reviews I've given for its exact status; an admin can also check Admin → Moderation. Double-blind release also waits up to the configured review window if the other side never reviews back
Build fails on Render with "vite: not found"	<code>NODE_ENV=production</code> made <code>npm ci</code> skip devDependencies	Already fixed in <code>render.yaml</code> (<code>--include=dev</code> on the build command)